

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 503

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to honor Hugh Harris on the occasion of his retirement from Franklin Christian Academy.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should specially recognize those outstanding professionals who have devoted their careers to providing the highest quality education; and

WHEREAS, Hugh Harris is one such estimable educator, who has distinguished himself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity, and is now retiring from his role as headmaster and president of Franklin Christian Academy; and

WHEREAS, growing up in Waco, Texas, and Gainesville, Florida, Mr. Harris graduated in 1978 from Baylor University with a degree in accounting, and he went on to work as an accountant in the insurance industry, serving in such important roles as a treasurer and vice president of finance; and

WHEREAS, in 1985, Mr. Harris began his own firm, which advised insurance companies in the realms of accounting and computer systems, and Mr. Harris and his beloved wife, Lisa, also moved their family, now with two adopted children, to work in an inner-city ministry that started a school, church, and multiple youth ministries; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Harris moved to Nashville in 1991 to work with a friend's newly formed venture, the Idea Agency, which produced life-affirming film, video, and music projects, and after nine full years of innovation and creation, he decided to join his wife in education and become the principal of a small Christian school in Franklin; and

WHEREAS, the Harrises, accompanied by twenty other families, began Franklin Christian Academy in 2004, and Mr. Harris immediately deployed his vast wealth of talent and knowledge accumulated over many years of multifarious work and interests to the benefit of the new academic institution; and

WHEREAS, a leader among leaders, Mr. Harris is the former president of the Middle Tennessee Athletic Conference and sat on the board of the National Christian Sports Conference, and to better serve his student body, he returned to school to further develop his administrative acumen, earning a Master of Education degree in Administration; and

WHEREAS, he is an extremely talented and compassionate educator who has worked assiduously throughout his career in education to motivate his students, fellow teachers, and staff to reach their full potential as scholars, professionals, and citizens; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Harris truly serves as an inspiration to his colleagues and students alike, and his friendship and counsel are highly valued by those who are fortunate to know him; and

WHEREAS, Hugh Harris epitomizes the dedicated educator who is wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for all, and he should be specially recognized as he ends his journey in education; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby thank Hugh Harris for his twenty-one years of service as headmaster and president of Franklin Christian Academy, commend his exceptional service to the children of Tennessee, salute his professional expertise and personal excellence, and wish him all the best in a fruitful retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.